



+= Claymore += GAME DESIGN

Oct 7 ▾

The game about a demon hunter adventures, inspired by the Claymore anime.

Me: Character development

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Start choices:

1. Look (hair,face)
2. Man/Woman
3. Pre-history

Phase-0: Human

childhood, events right before the attempt to become a claymore

Joining choices (youth, training):

1. Battle style: defend, attack, ballanced
2. Attributes distribution
3. Half-demon (powerful abilities) or quater-demon (trans control, learning)
4. Difficulty level

Phase-1. Claymore

killing demons, ruled by the Organization

Awakening (transformation is not restored):

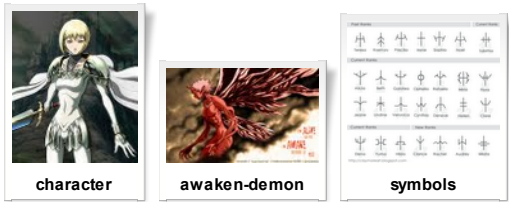
1. Gain some abilities automatically: blade fingers, transformation (to a human), fly
2. Choose the demon structure: wings, legs, size
3. Attributes change: -PERCEPTION, +STRENGTH

Phase-2. Demon

eating people, fighting with claymores & other demons

Me: Concept

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Me: Trans-meter

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Player can increase the trans-meter at any time, boosting the abilities and gaining new ones temporarily.
The more a demon-mode ability is used, the more chance it would become a standard-more ability.

The trans-meter shows the balance between human and demon. The ability to decrease the meter:

- depends on attributes (there is a limit, exceeding which the meter could not be decreased)
- depends on the surrounding events (a close human can help)

Me: Option: location-based transformation (advanced ability required to view and control it).

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Me: World

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The world is similar to Fallout-2: there is a global map, all known villages & towns are in it.
You can see it at any time. If the village has demons, it requests for help, what is seen on your map. The more time you lose, the less villagers will live. If no-one comes to save a village, it becomes an abandoned demon home.

Depending on the attribute (PERCEPTION) you can feel the surrounding auras in some distance. The aura has a color and a power, depending on the trans-meter of the remote something. Perception hints allow you to feel not just the power, but also what those creatures are doing and thinking of.

Some missions require a party to gather in a limited time (up to a week). You can see the gathering on the map, if help is requested. When you arrive at the meet point, the party moves together to a destination. You still control your own character at that time, but only in local space (global movement is defined by a party leader - the highest rank).

Me: Battle system

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At each pause moment you specify an action to be performed. After the action finishes, the pause is triggered allowing you to specify father actions.

Actions include:

- movement
- inventory usage
- instnant abilities, including regular attacks
- sustained abilities

Each ability has a primary attack (Pa) & defend attributes (Pd) it uses to check the resistance. The effect scale is computed is:

$$1.0 + 0.25 * \max(-4, Pa-Pd)$$

In a battle, one of the perks allows you to target the shots. A targetted shot have a smaller chance to hit, but may result in a limb cut:

- a lost leg greatly reduces your movement speed
- a lost right arm forces you to fight with the left one, reducing the strength
- damaged body leaves you immobile for a time to regenerate
- cut off head ends your life

Me: Hit system

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Human psychology understands only discrete signal form. Instead of the variable damage, we should use variable **probability** of a small set of possible outcomes:

- miss (0%)
- touch (20%) - wasn't able to dodge on time

- blocked hit (0-30%)
- direct hit (100%)

Me: Time system

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Turn based system is better for understanding the battle, but it's not suitable for interruption system in a fast-paced combat. Hence, pause-driven real-time combat fits better (Dragon Age, Baldur's Gate, etc).

You can **queue** commands (like move & attack). You can **interrupt** current command. There is a time penalty for interruption of a task as well as between tasks. There should be a passive ability to provide faster task switching for both continuation and interruption (or two separate abilities).

Me: Attributes

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Attributes are the numbers of character power in different areas:

- STRENGTH
- AGILITY
- CONTROL
- PERCEPTION
- WISDOM

There is a set of resulting variables:

- chance to hit (A+C)
- chance to dodge (A+P+W)
- detection distance (P)
- movement speed (A)
- trans-threshold (C+W)
- health (S)
- mana (W)
- attack damage (S)
- attack speed (A)

Me: Plot?

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Me: Multiplayer

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The game mechanics fits MMO style perfectly.

Me: Rank

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The player has a rank, which determines how other claymores treat you, and how dangerous missions are offered. He can see the rank in the nearest tavern.

There is also a set of statistics numbers:

- demons killed
- most powerful creature killed
- claymores killed
- awaken demons killed
- humans killed
- missions accomplished

The result of these numbers is your **karma**, which reflects the people's relation to you. Influences:

1. the market costs
2. dialog options
3. claymore hostility

Me: Human puppet

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You can have not more than one puppet. You control it as a part of your party. It is a child from the start, who joins you in one of visited towns (can be denied, though). The child is extremely weak in the battle, but have some useful abilities:

- morality boost
- basic fighting (can train, wear a sword)
- be a lure
- instant transformation restore

Me: Playing as a demon

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1. You don't earn experience points, and can't increase attributes or learn an ability.
2. You always want to eat. Not eating for a week kills you.
3. You still have a trans-meter, but you can control it freely in both ways. However, being in a human form you are much more vulnerable.

Me: Character stats

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Health - how much do you need to be hit (regenerates)

Mana - to spend on the abilities (regenerates)

Aarmor (different parts of the body) - reduces agility and damage from the attacks

The possible inventory entries:

- weapons (knives, swords)
- pills
- special (quest items)

Me: Abilities

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Human:

Trans drop - instantly zero the trans-level, active

Cheer - increase moral, sustained

Attack - basic sword attack

Claymore:

Rest - do nothing, while health/mana regenerates faster, sustained

Move - ..., active

Jump - ..., active

Heal - restore health of a damaged body part, active

Regenerate - restore heavy wounds or even a lost limb (Denev=N15), active
Attack - regular attack, active
Aimed attack - hit a particular body part, active
Remote attack - prolong an arm instantly to hit a distant enemy (Helen=N26?), active
Throw - throw weapon into the distant target, active
Defend - try to protect yourself, active
Dodge - try not to be hit, sustained
Micro attacks - perform a series of fast invisible attacks (learned from O2), active
Hyper blade - make one of the arms shake constantly to prevent the attack to be defended against (learned from N4), sustained (locks the hand)
Drill hand - make one hand twist, the energy is released with the following attack (learned from N9), sustained (locks the hand)
Control demon - affect the (demon) enemy attacks slightly to make them miss (learned from N3), sustained
Read energy - feel the demon energy in the opponent, dodging from it's attacks (learned from O1), shows you future enemy actions on the screen, sustained
Phantom - jump instantly, leaving a fake image behind (learned from N6), active
Demon legs - run like crazy, sustained, locked by trans
Demon wings - fly, sustained, locked by trans
Learn - try to imitate enemy's abilities, sustained
Hide - try to be invisible, sustained, can be discovered
Hide energy - suppress internal demon energy to prevent long-distant detection, sustained
Second weapon - fight with 2 weapons simultaneously, sustained
Watch - learn enemy's abilities, sustained
Hold rage - don't release rage, sustained
Detect - read long distance auras, sustained
Extract rage - convert rage to mana, active
Possess - take a demon creature under control for a time (mana is consumed in a rate higher for strong creatures), (new), sustained

Demon:

Me: Some of the abilities are obviously more advanced. There are several ways of a possible implementation in game:

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- difficulty of finding a teacher
- ability levels (3, for example, like in Starcraft/Warcraft)
- tech tree with dependencies (like in King's Bounty)

Me: **Learning**

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When you hit something and being hit yourselves, the rage meter is increased. Any following action will use the rage (decrease it) by increasing the ability power, what also serves as practice for those abilities that require used one. Enough theory & practice gives you an access to use the ability. There can be a sustained ability of holding the rage for a time frame in order to use it a bit later (skip using the rage on some actions).

Theory *learning* is another sustained ability that makes your character to watch over enemy's abilities. Activated once on the enemy, it adds some missing abilities to your graph (some still may require a higher *learn* ability level to be discovered). When activated, it gives you theory knowledge about a new ability in the following amount: (watch time) * (enemy's ability level).

Practicing already learned abilities increases their levels, especially when fighting strong enemies. That's a passive/sustained ability.

Me:

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processWave Editor

Please wait while the editor is loading...



Loading core features

Me: **Relationships**

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There is always a limited number of claymores in the world. They can be killed by demons, some can join their ranks. Each claymore's attitude to you can be influenced by your actions:

- helping on the battlefield to win or escape
- teaching an ability
- starting attitude depends on the character

Bad attitude results in a higher hostility - what means you may be their next target.

Claymores are overseen by the Organization, while demons have their own unions around the elder demons (the ones that were 1st before the awakening). Those unions have their own politics, allowing them to define spheres of influence and fight for them. You have an authority within the Organization, it grows with your exact order performance and decreases when you disobey orders. If you cross the rule, your authority drops very fast (by 20-30%) with a possibility of turning the Organization over you for a hunt. In the latter case you are on your own, and your chances to survive are small.

People are initially afraid of you, but their attitude changes with your karma.

Tags:

Images ▼

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